

Courier Operations Handbook

Internal Knowledge Base - Fictional Training Material

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Training notice: This is fictional material created for teaching retrieval-augmented generation.

1. Purpose and scope

- This handbook sets out the standard operating procedures for couriers completing AsterLane deliveries in the United Kingdom.
- Couriers must also follow road-safety law, site rules and instructions shown in the courier application. Where instructions conflict, safety and law take priority.

2. Collection procedure

- The courier must confirm the order reference before accepting goods from the collection point.
- The courier should check that the number of parcels matches the collection record. Sealed parcels must not be opened.
- Visible leakage, unsafe packaging or an item that cannot be transported securely must be reported before leaving the collection point.
- Once collection has been confirmed in the application, the delivery address must not be changed by the courier. Any requested address change must be referred to Courier Support.

3. Customer contact and waiting time

- On arrival, the courier should use the contact method provided in the application.
- If the customer does not respond, the courier must make at least two contact attempts over a minimum waiting period of five minutes.
- For attended deliveries, the courier must not mark the order as delivered unless the goods have been handed to the recipient or placed in an authorised safe location.
- Couriers may leave after the minimum waiting period when support has confirmed the next action or when the application provides a failed-delivery instruction.

4. Safe-location deliveries

- A parcel may be left in a safe location only when the customer selected or clearly authorised that location and the item is eligible for unattended delivery.
- A safe location must be dry, reasonably concealed from public view and accessible to the customer without entering another person's property.
- A communal hallway, pavement, doorstep visible from the street, waste bin or fire exit is not an acceptable safe location.
- Age-restricted goods, medication requiring handover, high-value items marked 'signature required', and goods that require temperature control must never be left unattended.

5. Proof of delivery

- The courier must capture proof of delivery in the application before leaving the location.
- For unattended delivery, proof should include a clear photograph showing the parcel and enough surrounding detail to identify the location without unnecessarily capturing people or private information.
- For attended delivery, the courier should record the recipient name or confirmation required by the application. A photograph of the customer is not required.
- A courier must never reuse an earlier delivery photograph, photograph an empty location, or enter false delivery notes.

6. Age-restricted deliveries

- The courier must follow the age-verification prompt in the application and may hand over the order only to an eligible recipient with acceptable identification.
- If acceptable identification is not produced, the courier must not complete the delivery and must contact Courier Support.
- An age-restricted order must never be left in a safe location, handed to a neighbour, or given to a person who appears intoxicated.

7. Address changes and delivery instructions

- A customer may add access information, such as a gate code or floor number, through support.
- A change that moves the delivery to a different building, street or postcode is an address change and requires support approval.
- Couriers must not accept a cash payment or private arrangement to deliver to a different address.
- If the new address is approved, the courier must follow the updated instruction shown in the application.

8. Incidents and safety

- Couriers should leave the area and contact emergency services where there is an immediate threat to life or safety.
- Threats, harassment, suspected illegal goods, road collisions, injuries and unsafe premises must be reported to Courier Support as soon as it is safe to do so.
- Couriers must not confront a customer about suspected fraud or attempt to recover goods by force.
- Any incident involving personal data being given to the wrong recipient must be reported immediately.

9. Expenses and compensation

- Standard fuel, vehicle maintenance and routine parking costs are included in the courier's normal payment and are not reimbursed.
- A courier may request reimbursement for a toll or congestion charge only when the route was instructed by AsterLane and the charge was not already included in the job payment.
- Waiting-time compensation may apply after ten minutes at a collection point when the delay has been recorded in the application. Customer-address waiting time is not automatically compensated.
- Compensation disputes must be submitted through the courier payment review process.